

FOR TEACHER USE ONLY

SWIM & WATER SAFETY

Teacher Resource Guide

A complete unit resource for Victorian secondary HPE teachers.
Lesson plans, answer keys, rubrics, differentiation & curriculum alignment.

Year 7–8

HPE Safety Focus Area

5 Lessons x 50 min

Victorian Curriculum F-10 v2.0

Dry-Land Ready

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1 Curriculum Alignment

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 — Health & Physical Education

Victorian government and Catholic schools must implement Curriculum 2.0 from 2026. Swimming and water safety is a **mandated priority area** alongside respectful relationships, embedded across both HPE strands.

Content Description	Code	Strand	How This Unit Addresses It
Investigate and select strategies to promote health, safety and wellbeing	VCHPEP126	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students investigate water safety strategies for Victorian contexts
Plan and use strategies to enhance health, safety and wellbeing of communities	VCHPEP130	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students develop personal action plans and community awareness activities
Develop skills to evaluate health information and express health concerns	VCHPEP129	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students analyse LSV drowning data and evaluate source credibility
Refine and perform specialised movement skills in aquatic environments	VCHPEM146	Movement & Physical Activity	Students apply survival swimming and rescue techniques
Examine barriers to seeking support and evaluate strategies	VCHPEP125	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students identify peer pressure as a barrier to safe decisions near water

Focus Areas — Victorian Curriculum 2.0

- **Safety (S)** — Core: safe practices near and in water, emergency response, recognising hazards
- **Lifelong Physical Activities (LPA)** — Swimming as a lifelong health-enhancing skill
- **Fundamental Movement Skills (FMS)** — Aquatic movement and survival skills

Achievement Standard Connections — Levels 7 & 8

By the end of Level 8, students are expected to:

- Investigate strategies that enhance their own and others' health, safety and wellbeing
- Justify actions that promote health, safety and wellbeing in community contexts
- Gather and analyse health information to make informed decisions
- Explain personal and social skills required to establish respectful relationships
- Demonstrate control and accuracy when performing specialised movement skills

Source: <https://victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10>

2 Unit Overview & Learning Intentions

Element	Detail
Unit Title	Swim & Water Safety: Making Smart Choices in Victorian Waters
Year Level	Year 7–8 (Ages 12–14)
Duration	4–6 x 50-minute lessons (expandable for swimming carnival unit)
Setting	Fully classroom-based / dry-land — no pool required + optional pool component
Key Resources	Student workbook, Poster pack (4 posters), Scenario activity cards (14 cards), Assessment gradebook, Resource directory
Partner Organisations	LSV, RLSSA Swim & Survive, Paddle Australia, Parks Victoria, VCAA, DE, St John Ambulance Victoria
Prerequisite Knowledge	Basic swimming at primary level; Victorian Water Safety Certificate (Foundation–Year 6)
Dry-land Suitability	All activities deliverable without water access — explicitly supported by Curriculum 2.0 and LSV Toolkit

Learning Intentions — What students will Know, Understand, and Do:

KNOW	UNDERSTAND	DO
• Current Victorian drowning statistics • Beach flag system and meanings • DRS ABCD action plan • LSV SwimSafe 5 rules • What a rip current is • Cold water shock effects • Key risk factors for young people • Throw rescue hierarchy	• Why unpatrolled locations are more dangerous • Why young males are overrepresented in drowning data • How peer pressure influences risky decisions near water • Why alcohol and water is a deadly combination • The relationship between knowledge, skills and safety outcomes	• Apply DRS ABCD in a simulated emergency • Analyse and interpret drowning data • Make and justify safe decisions in scenarios • Rank and demonstrate throw rescue choices • Map hazards across Victorian water environments • Create a water safety communication product • Locate patrolled beaches using the BeachSafe app

Essential Questions

- Why does Victoria have such a high drowning rate compared to its population size?
- What decisions, information and skills could prevent most Victorian drowning deaths?
- How do social factors (peer pressure, gender norms, overconfidence) increase risk near water?
- What is my personal responsibility to be water safe and to help keep others safe?
- Why are rivers and inland waterways just as dangerous — or more so — than the beach?

3 Lesson Plans

LESSON

1

Victoria's Drowning Crisis — Why It Matters to You

50 min | Workbook Section 1 | VCHPEP126, VCHPEP129 | Classroom

■ ENGAGE

10 min

Opening Hook — "Could This Be You?"

- Begin with: "Name the THREE closest bodies of water to where you live." Think-pair-share (2 min), then class map on whiteboard.
- Show the statistic: "In 2023-24, 54 people drowned in Victoria. All deaths happened at unpatrolled locations. Nearly 1 in 5 were aged 15-24."
- Ask: "What does this make you feel? Were you surprised? Why or why not?"

■ EXPLORE

15 min

Data Investigation

- Students complete Workbook Activity 1.1 (personal connection survey) independently — 5 min.
- Students examine the data table in Activity 1.2 and complete the "What does this tell us?" column — 8 min.
- If internet available: students visit lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/ to cross-reference data.

■ EXPLAIN

15 min

Teacher-Led Discussion: Why Teenagers Are at Risk

- Walk through key risk factors using Poster 3 as visual reference (display on projector or print A3).
- Discuss: peer pressure, risk-taking during adolescence, gender and risk-taking behaviour, cultural background, overconfidence.
- Key point: "The circumstances leading to drowning often come up quickly, in social settings, exactly like where you go in summer."

— ELABORATE

8 min

Written Responses (Questions 1.2a and 1.2b)

- Students complete Questions 1.2a and 1.2b in workbooks independently.
- Circulate to check understanding. Prompt: "Look at the data about WHERE drownings happen. What does that tell you?"

■ EVALUATE / EXIT

5 min

Exit Ticket

- On a sticky note: "Write ONE fact from today that surprised you and ONE question you still have."
- Collect at the door. Use questions to guide Lesson 2 content.

LESSON
2

Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival

50 min | Workbook Section 2 | VCHPEP126 | Classroom

■ ENGAGE

8 min

Flag Quiz — Prior Knowledge Probe

- Show images of 6 beach flags (from Poster 2) on projector — no labels.
- Students write on mini-whiteboards or paper what each flag means.
- Quick show of hands: "Who always swims between the flags?" Validate correct answers, address misconceptions.

■ EXPLORE

12 min

Flag Identification Activity (Workbook 2.1)

- Students complete Activity 2.1 flag identification in workbooks independently.
- Then peer-check with a partner using Poster 2 as a reference.
- Whole-class share: which flag did most students get wrong? Discuss why.

■ EXPLAIN

12 min

Rip Currents — Teacher Explanation with Diagram

- Use the rip current diagram in the student workbook (projected) to explain how rip currents form and how to escape.
- Key analogy: "A rip current is like a conveyor belt in the ocean. You can't run against a conveyor belt — you step sideways off it."
- Watch: SLSA rip current video at sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/ (approx 3-4 min)

— ELABORATE

12 min

Scenario Analysis — Liam's Story + Scenario Cards

- Students read the Liam scenario and answer Questions 2.2a-c in workbooks.
- Encourage use of specific vocabulary: rip current, patrolled beach, parallel to shore, conserve energy.
- Optional station rotation: Scenario Cards B1 (Unpatrolled Beach), B2 (Caught in a Rip), B3 (The Flag Problem). Groups rotate every 8 minutes.

■ EVALUATE

6 min

BeachSafe App Demo + SwimSafe Rules Introduction

- Demonstrate BeachSafe at beachsafe.org.au — show students how to find their nearest patrolled beach.
- Task: "Find the 3 nearest patrolled beaches to your home using BeachSafe." (homework or in class)
- Preview Poster 4 (SwimSafe Rules) — quick verbal run-through of the 5 rules.

LESSON
3

Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills

50 min | Workbook Section 3 | VCHPEP126, VCHPEP130, VCHPEM146 | Classroom + Practical

■ ENGAGE

5 min

DRS ABCD — Reveal Game

- 7 chairs at the front, numbered 1-7. Each has a letter card face down (D, R, S, A, B, C, D).
- Ask 7 volunteers to flip their cards. Class guesses the word for each letter.
- Award house points for correct answers to build engagement.

■ EXPLORE

15 min

CPR Demonstration + Practice

- Use a CPR manikin (or demonstrate on a cushion/rolled-up mat).
- Demonstrate: head tilt-chin lift, check breathing (10 sec), 30 chest compressions at 100-120 bpm (5-6cm depth), 2 rescue breaths.
- Students practise compressions in pairs on cushions/mats. Emphasise: "Harder than you think — don't be afraid to push."
- Hands-only CPR is acceptable if students are uncomfortable with rescue breaths.

■ EXPLAIN

8 min

Throw Rescue Technique

- Demonstrate throw rescue: throw the rope/towel so it lands PAST the person, so they can grab the floating end.
- Practise with a coiled rope or bundle of towels (classroom version: scrunched t-shirt).
- Key message: "You do NOT need to enter the water. A throw rescue can save a life from the bank."

— ELABORATE

15 min

Workbook Activities 3.1 and 3.2 + Scenario Cards

- Students complete DRS ABCD table (Activity 3.1) and River Rope Swing scenario (Activity 3.2) in pairs.
- Discussion prompt: "What is the FIRST thing you do before approaching someone who is injured?"
- Scenario Cards E1 (Calling 000) and E2 (Throw Rescue) work well as pair/group follow-on tasks.

■ EVALUATE

7 min

Role-Play Check

- One pair at a time role-play calling 000 using the DRS ABCD sequence.
- One person is the caller; teacher plays dispatcher. Other students observe and provide feedback.

LESSON

4

Hazard Mapping, Safe Decisions, Inland Waterways & Alcohol

50 min | Workbook Sections 4-5 | VCHPEP125, VCHPEP126 | Classroom

■ ENGAGE

8 min

"Would You?" — Values Clarification

- Students stand left ("I would") or right ("I wouldn't") for three scenarios read aloud.
- Scenarios: jumping off cliff into lake on a dare / swimming in a river with no lifeguard on a hot day / swimming at a pool party after drinking.
- These directly mirror Scenario Cards D1 (The Group Decision) and D2 (Alcohol & Water) — use as written follow-on tasks.

■ EXPLORE

15 min

Hazard Mapping + SwimSafe Rules

- Students complete Activity 4.0 Hazard Mapping — identifying and ranking hazards across beach, river/dam, and pool. Groups of 2-3.
- Introduce the LSV SwimSafe 5 Rules using Poster 4. Students copy rules into workbook Section 4.
- Whole-class debrief: which environment is most dangerous? Why do rivers/dams account for most Victorian drowning deaths?

■ EXPLAIN

10 min

Inland Waterways + Cold Water Shock — Victorian Context

- Explain cold water shock: involuntary gasp reflex, hyperventilation, rapid heart rate increase, muscle incapacitation.
- Victorian context: "Alpine lakes like Lake Eildon are fed by snowmelt. Even in December they can sit at 12-15C."
- Reference Paddle Australia (paddle.org.au) and Parks Victoria (park.vic.gov.au) for inland waterway safety.
- Scenario Cards R2 (After the Rain) and R3 (Cold Water Shock) work well as 5-minute quick writes.

— ELABORATE

12 min

Activities 4.1, 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4

- Students complete Risk vs. Benefit Analysis (4.1) and Question 4.1a (peer pressure strategy) in pairs.
- Activity 5.2 Throw Rescue ranking — reinforces RLSSA hierarchy. Debrief: why is "jumping in" consistently ranked last?
- Activity 5.3 Alcohol and Water — frame as a public health fact: "This is about understanding risk, not making judgements."
- Activity 5.4 Diving, Shallow Water & Spinal Injury — see teacher note below. Cold-open with the six-stat data block before revealing the topic.

■ EVALUATE

5 min

Gallery Walk — SwimSafe Commitment

- Students share the SwimSafe rule most important to them (Workbook 6.1b) with a partner and explain reasoning.
- Optional: post sticky notes under each of the 5 SwimSafe rules — which does the class think is most critical?

LESSON
5

Personal Action Plan & Communication Campaign

50 min | Workbook Section 6 | VCHPEP129, VCHPEP130 | Classroom | Assessment

■ ENGAGE

8 min

Review Quiz + Scenario Card Showdown

- Quick Kahoot or Quizlet revision quiz covering beach flags, DRS ABCD, SwimSafe rules, rip current escape, and Victorian statistics.
- Optional 3-min rapid fire: project one scenario card (e.g. Card R1 or P1) — whole class calls out the correct action. Teacher confirms with the answer reveal.

— ELABORATE

30 min

Assessment Task: Communication Campaign (Workbook Activity 6.2)

- Option A — Social media post for teenagers (Instagram/TikTok style, 1-2 slides). Must include a statistic with source URL and a call to action.
- Option B — Letter to a Year 5 student (~200 words) explaining three things they must know about water safety before summer.
- Option C (Extension) — Multilingual community fact sheet for someone new to Australia. Strongly recommended for CALD students — encourage use of home language.
- Teacher tip: Encourage students to cite LSV, Parks Victoria, or Paddle Australia as sources.

■ EVALUATE

12 min

Workbook Collection + Self-Assessment + Peer Share

- Students complete the 8-criteria self-assessment checklist in their workbook.
- Optional peer share: 2 min each — partner gives feedback: "One thing that would make this more persuasive is..."
- Collect completed workbooks for teacher marking using the Assessment Gradebook rubric.

4 Student Workbook — Answer Key

Section 1: Victorian Drowning Statistics

Activity 1.2 — Data Table (What does this tell us?) [interpretive — accept variety]

54 deaths: Victoria's drowning rate in 2023-24 was the highest in over a decade. Young people (15-24): Young people are significantly overrepresented — youth alone is not protective. Gender (46 of 54 male): Males take more physical risks near water, often influenced by peer pressure or overconfidence. All at unpatrolled sites: If everyone swam only at patrolled locations, the death toll could theoretically be near zero.

Q 1.2a — TWO reasons teenagers are at higher risk [2 marks, 1 per valid reason]

Accept any two of: risk-taking behaviour common in adolescence; peer pressure to swim in unsafe places; overconfidence in swimming ability; tendency to swim at unpatrolled locations; lack of awareness of hidden dangers like rip currents or cold water; social norms around not "backing down" from dares.

Q 1.2b — What unpatrolled location data suggests [2 marks]

The fact that all drownings occurred at unpatrolled locations suggests that trained lifeguards and supervision are extremely effective at preventing drowning deaths. Swimming at patrolled beaches/pools dramatically reduces risk because someone is watching and able to respond in seconds.

Section 2: Beach Flags & Rip Currents

Activity 2.1 — Flag Identification

Flag 1: Red & Yellow — Patrolled swimming area; always swim here. Flag 2: Red — Dangerous conditions; experienced swimmers only. Flag 3: Black & White Quartered — Surfboards/watercraft zone; swimmers stay out. Flag 4: Yellow + Black Ball — No surfboards; swimming only. Flag 5: Orange Windsock — Offshore winds; no inflatables. Flag 6: Purple — Dangerous marine life spotted; swim with caution.

Q 2.2a — THREE steps if caught in a rip [3 marks, 1 per valid step]

1. Stay calm and do not panic — conserve energy. 2. Float or tread water rather than fighting the current. 3. Swim parallel to the shore (not directly in) to escape the current's channel, then angle back to shore. If unable to reach shore, raise one arm and call/signal for help.

Q 2.2b — Why swimming against a rip is dangerous [2 marks]

A rip current can move at speeds up to 2.5 m/s — faster than most swimmers can sprint. Swimming directly against it uses enormous energy very quickly, leading to exhaustion and then drowning. The swimmer makes no progress, becomes panicked, and loses the ability to stay afloat.

Q 2.2c — Liam's scenario: TWO mistakes [4 marks]

Mistake 1: Swimming at an unpatrolled beach. They should have gone to a patrolled beach with lifeguards. Mistake 2: Liam tried to swim directly against the rip, exhausting himself. He should have stayed calm, floated, swum parallel to shore, and if needed, raised his arm to signal for help. Bonus: his friends didn't know to call 000 immediately or throw something that floats.

Section 3: DRS ABCD & Rescue

Activity 3.1 — DRS ABCD words

D — DANGER | R — RESPONSE | S — SEND (call 000) | A — AIRWAY | B — BREATHING | C — CPR | D — DEFIBRILLATION

Q 3.2a — First action at River Rope Swing [2 marks]

Do NOT jump in. Call 000 (or shout for someone else to call while you act). Then use the rope from the swing to throw to the person (throw rescue). This is safer than entering water and risking becoming another casualty.

Q 3.2b — Why the friend jumping in was dangerous [2 marks]

The untrained friend who jumped in creates a second casualty risk. When a person is drowning, they involuntarily grab anything within reach and may push the rescuer underwater in their panic. Without rescue training, entering the water dramatically increases the chance of two drownings.

Section 4: SwimSafe, Hazard Mapping & Decision-Making

Activity 4.0 — Hazard Mapping [accept well-reasoned responses]

*Beach (patrolled): Rip currents (H), sunburn (M), jellyfish (M), rough surf (H), swimming outside flags (H).
River/Dam: Cold water shock (H), submerged objects (H), strong currents after rain (H), no lifeguard (H), unknown depth (H). Pool: Unsupervised children (H), diving into shallow end (H), no adult supervision (H).*

Q 4.0a — Most dangerous environment + evidence [2 marks]

Rivers and dams are most dangerous overall. The LSV 2023-24 data shows all 54 Victorian drowning deaths occurred at unpatrolled locations, and inland waterways accounted for the majority. Unlike patrolled beaches, rivers have no lifeguard supervision, cold water shock risk, hidden currents, and conditions that change rapidly.

Activity 4 — LSV SwimSafe 5 Rules

1. Read signs | 2. Enter feet first | 3. Stay in depth | 4. Swim with a friend | 5. Signal for help. Source: Life Saving Victoria — [lsv.com.au](https://www.lsv.com.au)

Activity 5.2 — Throw Rescue Ranking [accept logical reasoning]

1st: Life ring attached to jetty (attached, won't sink, can be pulled back). 2nd: Coiled rope/throw bag (can throw to distance and pull person in). 3rd: Towel/clothing from bank (limited reach, only effective if person is close). 4th: Throwing pool noodle/esky lid (buoyant but no line to pull person in). 5th: Jumping in — most dangerous, only if trained with flotation device.

Q 5.3a — THREE ways alcohol increases drowning risk [3 marks]

Accept any three of: impaired judgement (overestimates ability); reduced coordination; slowed reaction time; impaired body temperature regulation (hypothermia risk in cold water); false confidence leading to unsafe locations; reduced ability to hold breath.

Q 5.3b — TWO specific risks — alcohol + pool party [2 marks]

Accept any two of: night-time swimming means poor visibility; alcohol impairs depth/distance assessment; CPR response is complicated by alcohol use of bystanders; a person who goes unconscious may not be noticed; alcohol-affected friends are less likely to identify an emergency and respond correctly.

Q 5.4a — Why students in the 10-14 male age group face higher risk [2 marks]

Accept well-reasoned responses connecting: peer pressure and dares near water; showing off to a group; overconfidence in swimming ability; underestimating depth change; not wanting to appear fearful. A-standard response identifies a specific social mechanism, not just "males take risks." E.g.: "When someone dares you in front of a group, refusing feels embarrassing — so the social pressure overrides the safety judgement."

Q 5.4b — Why "I've done it here before" is dangerous [2 marks]

Key points: (1) water depth changes constantly — sandbanks form due to tidal action, sediment, rainfall, drought, dam releases; (2) the Bawley Beach case shows a sandbank formed between visits — prior safe experience created false confidence that the conditions were unchanged; (3) checking depth must happen every single visit, not just the first. Reject: responses that focus on "being careful" without explaining WHY conditions change.

Q 5.4c — Realistic intervention if friend about to dive into unknown water [2 marks]

Accept realistic, specific responses — not generic "I would tell them it's unsafe." A-standard: "I'd say 'Let's just check how deep it is first — we can jump in feet-first and feel the bottom. If it's deep enough, we'll know for sure.' This reframes caution as preparation, not fear, which is more likely to work socially." Also accept: pointing out the Feet First rule; asking if anyone knows about recent flooding or sandbanks; suggesting a patrolled alternative location.

5 Assessment Strategies & Rubric

Task	Type	Timing	Worth
Exit tickets (Lessons 1, 2, 3)	Formative	End of each lesson	Ungraded — teacher feedback
Student workbook (Sections 1-6, incl. Activities 4.0, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4)	Summative	Collected end of unit	40% of unit grade
CPR / rescue role-play observation	Formative practical	Lesson 3	Teacher observation checklist
Communication campaign task (Activity 6.2 — Options A, B, or C)	Summative	Lesson 5 / homework	60% of unit grade

Workbook Marking Rubric (7 Criteria)

The full 7-criteria interactive A-E rubric with report comment generator is in the separate Assessment Gradebook file. This abbreviated rubric is suitable for quick marking and oral feedback.

Criteria	E — Emerging	C — Consolidating	A — Extending
Hazard ID & Risk Assessment (VCHPEP126)	Names only obvious hazards; no ranking or explanation	Identifies key hazards across most environments; some explanation of risk level	Systematically identifies/ranks hazards; explains mechanisms of danger; supports with Victorian evidence
Water Safety Knowledge (VCHPEP126)	Demonstrates minimal or inaccurate knowledge	Demonstrates sound knowledge; mostly accurate beach flags, DRS ABCD, SwimSafe rules	Comprehensive, accurate knowledge; connects to broader prevention principles; uses specific terminology
LSV SwimSafe Rules (VCHPEP126)	Cannot recall most rules; cannot apply them	Recalls most rules accurately; applies in at least one scenario	Recalls all 5 rules; applies across different waterway types; explains which is most personally relevant
Application to Scenarios (VCHPEP125, 126)	Responses are superficial; doesn't apply DRS ABCD or flag knowledge correctly	Applies most correct steps; some logical gaps in scenarios	Consistently applies procedures; clearly justifies decisions; shows critical thinking
Throw Rescue & Emergency Response (VCHPEP130)	Unable to rank rescue options; does not understand why entering water is dangerous	Ranks rescue options mostly correctly; understands throw rescue principle	Accurately ranks and justifies rescue hierarchy using RLSSA framework; explains secondary drowning risk
Personal Action Plan (VCHPEP126)	Generic or incomplete; "I will be careful" type answers	Specific to own life; at least two realistic commitments; chosen scenario plan has key elements	Highly specific, realistic, personalised; shows genuine reflection on own habits and risks
Communication Campaign (VCHPEP129, 130)	Incomplete; vague message; no clear audience; no data used	Clear message; appropriate for audience; includes one relevant fact with source; mostly correct	Compelling, audience-appropriate content; accurate data with source URL; clear evidence-based call to action

6 Differentiation & Inclusion

CALD Students (Culturally & Linguistically Diverse)

- CALD communities accounted for nearly 40% of Victorian drowning deaths in 2023-24 — the highest ever recorded. This unit is particularly important for CALD students.
- LSV provides translated water safety resources in Arabic, Vietnamese, Chinese, Somali, and other languages: lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/
- Victorian Government multilingual resources: vic.gov.au/water-safety
- Pair CALD students with supportive peers for scenario activities; allow translation of key terms using home language or digital tools.
- Communication Campaign Option C (multilingual fact sheet) is specifically designed for CALD students — encourage creation in home language to extend community reach.
- When discussing fishing-related drowning (more than half of fishing deaths involve CALD backgrounds), handle with cultural sensitivity — frame as information, not judgment.

Extension Students (High Achieving)

- Assign Extension Scenario Cards X1, X2, and X3 (data analysis, communication campaign, physiology of drowning).
- Research task: Compare LSV drowning report data with national RLSSA data. What are the key differences between Victorian and other state/territory rates?
- Design a school swim safety awareness week proposal including activities, guest speakers from LSV, and RLSSA resources.
- Run all 14 Scenario Cards as a timed group challenge — groups compete to correctly answer the most. Works well as end-of-unit review.
- Compare dry-land water safety education approaches between Australia (LSV/RLSSA), UK (RLSS UK), and USA (Red Cross).

Students with Additional Needs

- Workbook activities can be completed verbally with a scribe or using speech-to-text tools.
- CPR practical component: students with physical limitations can observe and provide verbal guidance — full marks available for verbal accuracy.
- Simplified answer scaffolds: sentence starters, word banks, visual cue cards.
- For the Communication Campaign (Activity 6.2), the oral option (presenting to teacher or small group) is a valid and fully assessable alternative.
- The SwimSafe 5 rules (Poster 4) make a strong visual memory support — laminate a personal copy for students who benefit from visual cues.

Non-Swimmers and Students Who Avoid Water

- This unit is fully classroom-based and dry-land. No student should feel embarrassed about swimming ability levels.
- Activity 1.1 (swimming ability self-rating) is for the student's personal reflection only — do not ask students to share this publicly.
- Frame consistently: "Being water smart is not about being a great swimmer — it's about making safe decisions before and after you get near water."
- The SwimSafe rules and DRS ABCD are equally important for non-swimmers — recognising dangerous situations before entering water is the most critical skill.

7 Teacher Background Knowledge

Key Water Safety Facts for Teachers

- **The 1-10-1 rule (cold water):** Approximately 1 minute to control breathing after sudden cold water immersion; 10 minutes of useful swimming ability before muscle coordination fails; up to 1 hour of survival time before hypothermia (for most adults).
- **Rip currents:** Account for approximately 80% of lifeguard rescues at Australian beaches. They are NOT undertows — they move laterally, not downward. They are actually calmer-looking water between breaking waves.
- **CPR rates:** Bystander CPR doubles or triples survival rates for cardiac arrest. CPR should start within 4 minutes of cardiac arrest to preserve brain function.
- **Throw, don't go:** Most non-professional bystander drownings occur when a friend or family member attempts an in-water rescue without training. A throw rescue from the bank is always safer.
- **AEDs:** Automated External Defibrillators are in many Victorian public spaces. They will not shock a heart that does not need it. Know where your school's AED is before teaching this unit.
- **CALD drowning risk:** People from CALD backgrounds who did not learn to swim as children face significantly higher drowning risk. Fishing and recreational activities near water are particularly high-risk settings.

8 Resources & Sources

Victorian Curriculum (VCAA)

HPE Curriculum F-10 Version 2.0, content descriptions and achievement standards

<https://victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10>

<https://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au/curriculum/foundation-10/curriculum-area-resources/health-and-physical-education/teaching-resources>

Life Saving Victoria (LSV)

Primary Victorian resource. Drowning reports, classroom lessons, SwimSafe program, multicultural resources

<https://lsv.com.au>

https://lsv.com.au/toolkit/classroom_based_water_safety.php

<https://lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/>

<https://lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/>

Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA)

Swim & Survive program, Bronze e-Lifesaving, dry-land classroom modules, throw rescue guidelines

<https://www.royallifesaving.com.au>

<https://www.drowningprevention.org.au/swimandsurvive>

Victorian Department of Education

Swimming policy, funding, toolkit, excursion guidelines

<https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy>

<https://www.education.vic.gov.au/school/teachers/teachingresources/discipline/phised/Pages/swimmingsafety.aspx>

Paddle Australia

Inland waterway safety — rivers, lakes, moving water. Victorian river context.

<https://paddle.org.au>

Parks Victoria

Victorian natural environment waterway hazards. Excellent for localised classroom scenarios.

<https://www.park.vic.gov.au>

AUSTSWIM

National swimming teacher training frameworks; lesson progression models; inclusion strategies

<https://austswim.com.au>

BeachSafe (Surf Life Saving Australia)

Free app showing patrolled beaches, patrol hours, conditions. Student research task.

<https://beachsafe.org.au>

<https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/>

St John Ambulance Victoria

DRS ABCD, CPR, first aid resources; free printable guides for classroom use

<https://www.stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/>

Victorian Government Water Safety

Multilingual resources, beach water quality, inland waterway guidance

<https://www.vic.gov.au/water-safety>

<https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety>

American Red Cross — Water Safety

"Think So You Don't Sink" decision-making model. Engaging videos for teens.

<https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety>

CDC Drowning Prevention (USA)

International data for numeracy cross-curricular comparison tasks; risk factor research

<https://www.cdc.gov/drowning/prevention>

RLSS UK — Education Resources

International classroom lesson plans; rescue decision-making frameworks. Free downloads.

<https://www.rlss.org.uk/education>

Your Complete Package — File Summary

File	Purpose	Primary Use
swim_safety_poster_pack	4 A3 classroom posters	Display throughout unit; visual reference all lessons
swim_safety_student_workbook	6-section student workbook, ~35 activities	Distributed to students; used across all 5 lessons; collected as summative evidence
swim_safety_teacher_workbook	This document	Teacher planning and delivery; not for student distribution
swim_safety_student_workbook_PRINT	B&W; print-optimised workbook (colour only where needed)	Cheaply photocopied as class set; colour only for Activities 2.1 and 2.2
water_safety_resource_directory	11 organisations with URLs and teaching notes	Teacher reference; share with HPE faculty
water_safety_scenario_cards	14 printable scenario cards + 3 extension cards	Print and laminate; station activities, pair tasks, review games
water_safety_assessment_grade_book	4-tab tool: rubric, curriculum codes, class tracker, report comment generator	Assessment and reporting; generates curriculum-aligned report comments
swim_safety_lesson_outline_year7	Student-facing lesson outline with learning intentions and success criteria	Distributed to Year 7 students at unit start; self-assessment tool